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Research Interests

- Empirical asset pricing
- Political uncertainty, populism, and financial markets
- Derivatives, option pricing, and volatility modelling
- Financial econometrics and reproducible empirical methods

Working Papers

What Drives the Price of Populism? Liberal Commitments and Market Perceptions of Political Risk *Work in progress*

- Combines text-based populism and liberalism measures with option-implied risk measures to study how political uncertainty is priced in equity markets, using an event-study design around elections.

Presentations

APF International Conference of Macroeconomics and Finance

Athens University of Economics and Business, Athens, Greece

July 2026

- “What Drives the Price of Populism? Liberal Commitments and Market Perceptions of Political Risk.”

Education

PhD in Business Economics (Financial Economics)

University of Liechtenstein, Vaduz, Liechtenstein

2025 – Present

- Cumulative PhD thesis based on research papers in financial economics.

MSc in Economics (Quantitative Finance Specialization)

University of Freiburg, Germany

Oct 2022 – Nov 2024

- **Key Courses:** Principles of Finance, Portfolio Management, Derivatives Pricing, Futures and Options, Industrial Organization, Intermediate Econometrics, Python Programming, Computational Economics.
- **Seminars:** Econometric Risk Management in Finance, Quantitative Finance (Credit Risk), Topics in Macroeconomics – involving written reports and formal presentations.
- **Thesis:** “Option Pricing Models Beyond the Black-Scholes Framework” – implementation of Heston, Variance Gamma, and SABR models in Python on S&P 500 implied-volatility data, pricing Heston and Variance Gamma via the COS (Fourier-cosine) method on their characteristic functions.
- **Grade Average:** 1.9 (German grading system).

BSc in Economics (Management and Finance Specialization)

University of Ss. Cyril and Methodius, North Macedonia

Oct 2018 – Jul 2022

- **Key Courses:** Financial Management, Investment Management, Econometrics, Time Series Analysis, Quantitative Methods in Finance, Financial Econometrics, Management Accounting.
- **Thesis:** “Impact of Digitalization on Economic Growth” – panel data econometric analysis using EViews; included a cross-sectional comparison of digitalization in North Macedonia.
- **Grade Average:** 9.2 (Macedonian grading system).

Professional Experience

Research Assistant (50%) and PhD Student

University of Liechtenstein, Vaduz, Liechtenstein

July 2025 – Present

- Conduct empirical research in financial economics, with emphasis on asset pricing, derivatives, and political uncertainty.
- Support research projects, reproducible empirical analysis, seminar preparation, and teaching-related activities.

Product Control Intern

HypoVereinsbank (UniCredit), Munich, Germany

Nov 2024 – May 2025

- Analyzed daily P&L decomposition for Equity and FICC desks, identifying unexplained drivers, and ensuring logical consistency.
- Collaborated with traders to resolve discrepancies and apply adjustments using internal systems and analytical tools.
- Delivered accurate and timely P&L reports to senior management.
- Developed VBA macros to automate Excel-based workflows, improving reporting efficiency.

Project Leader – Erasmus+ Remote Internship

CIVITTA, Estonia

Mar 2022 – Jun 2022

- Led a student consulting team to develop a business expansion plan for an IT company entering the North Macedonian market.
- Coordinated tasks, ensured milestone delivery, and facilitated team communication.
- Built a financial model in Excel that included break-even analysis and IRR forecasts over a two-year horizon.

Finance Intern – Coke Summership Program

Pivara Skopje (Heineken/Coca-Cola HBC)

Jul 2021 – Aug 2021

- Supported financial operations, including contract processing and sales performance analysis.
- Contributed to marketing and sales initiatives by facilitating contracts and customer communication.
- Gained experience in time management, presentation, and cross-functional collaboration.

Certificates

Applied Data Science Lab – WorldQuant University

Completed April 2025

- Completed project-based training in Python, SQL, data visualization, and machine learning.
- Built end-to-end data analysis pipelines, cleaned and analyzed real-world datasets, and developed predictive models.
- Final projects included portfolio risk analysis, SQL database querying, and interactive dashboards.

Technical Skills

- **Programming:** Python (Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, Matplotlib), R, SQL, LaTeX, VBA.
- **Tools & Environments:** Excel, Power BI, Word, PowerPoint, PowerQuery, EViews, Jupyter Notebook, PyCharm.

Languages

- **Macedonian:** Native
- **Croatian:** B1 – Fluent
- **English:** C1 – Advanced
- **German:** B1 – Intermediate